The Mixed-Team Operating Rhythm

You don't need a second management system for AI. Bring AI into the one you already have.

From ***AI Will Scale Good Leadership and Bad Leadership:*** *The CHRO's Method for Redesigning Work Before AI Scales What's Broken* by Liz Corey · Toolbox No. 10

Somewhere in your company right now, a manager is already running a team where people and agents produce work side by side, whether anyone designed for that or not. The rhythm below puts the agent inside the management system the team already runs. Four cadences, each tied to a meeting that already exists.

Daily, or by work cycle — Look at the flow of work.

Human work and agent work sit in one queue. Handoffs are visible. Escalations are reaching named people within the expected response time.

Ask out loud: Where is work waiting on a handoff nobody can see?

Owner: _____ **Lives in (existing meeting):** _____

Weekly — Review agent performance alongside team performance.

Output, exceptions, escalations, errors, and a sample of actual work. Reward people for catching problems early. A near miss surfaced quickly is evidence that the control system worked.

Ask out loud: What did we catch this week, and who caught it?

Owner: _____ **Lives in (existing meeting):** _____

Monthly — Review the human portfolio.

People still have meaningful judgment, relationship, problem-solving, and development work. Look for employees who are quietly becoming full-time exception handlers.

Ask out loud: Whose job has quietly become exception handling?

Owner: _____ **Lives in (existing meeting):** _____

Quarterly — Revalidate the system.

Decision rights, Agent Job Descriptions, escalation rules, and supervision levels. Was the capacity AI created reinvested where the redesign said it would be? Put the results on the quarterly business review agenda.

Ask out loud: Did the freed capacity go where we said it would?

Owner: _____ **Lives in (existing meeting):** _____

The payoff. The mixed team becomes managed rather than merely tolerated. The manager knows what the agent owns, the people know what they own, everyone knows where judgment sits, and when something goes wrong, everyone knows who acts.

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THE CHRO'S MOVE

Map one mixed team in an hour

Find the manager who is already running the most mixed team. They exist, even if nobody has called their team that yet. Sit with them for an hour and map the work. Then help them make the invisible system visible.

Manager: **Team:** **Date:**

Which tasks are being done by people?

Which are being assisted by AI?

Which are automated?

Which have effectively been delegated to agents?

Where do the handoffs happen?

Where do exceptions land?

Who is actually checking the output?

What have their people's jobs quietly become?

What happens when the technology gets something wrong, and who do they call when it breaks?

Before you leave the room

- ☐ Work clarified
- ☐ Ownership clarified
- ☐ Judgment points named
- ☐ Escalation paths named
- ☐ Human development work protected
- ☐ Agent performance in the normal rhythm

Then let other managers learn from what this one discovers.

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WEEKLY

Agent performance review card

Ten minutes inside the team meeting you already hold. Agent performance beside team performance, never in a separate meeting.

Team: _____ **Week of:** _____ **Agent:** _____

Agent output this week (volume)	
Exceptions	
Escalations, and were they on time?	
Errors found	
Sample of actual work reviewed (how many)	
One near miss caught early, and who caught it (say thank you out loud)	
One fix made at the source, not the output (the brief, the context, or the standard)	

MONTHLY

Human portfolio check

One row per person. Tick the kinds of work they still meaningfully do. A row with nothing ticked is the quiet exception handler the rhythm exists to catch.

PERSON	JUDGMENT	RELATIONSHIP	PROBLEM SOLVING	DEVELOPMENT	IF MOSTLY EXCEPTIONS: WHAT CHANGES
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	

None of this should frighten you. These aren't new management skills. They're management. AI may change who or what does the work. It does not change who is accountable for how the work gets done. That is still the manager.

The conversations in this rhythm run on one structure. The GROWTH Execution Partner walks a leader through Goal, Reflect, Options, What's Next, Tracking, and Habits for any of them. Call for pricing. Book a conversation at onthegrow.ai

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